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RE: VGIC Comments in Response to Working Group Facilitator's Request: Proposed Rollout Plan, Proposed Incentives, and Island Requirement

VGIC commends the Bidirectional EV Working Group for a robust and comprehensive process to develop a report in response to the Connecticut Public Utilities Regulatory Authority's (PURA's) December 17th, 2025, final decision in Docket No. 25-08-05. In the decision, PURA created the Bidirectional EV Working Group to develop recommendations for incorporating bidirectional EVs into Connecticut's Energy Storage Solutions (ESS) Program.

The working group facilitator requested member feedback on the proposed rollout plan, proposed incentives, and island requirement. VGIC welcomes the opportunity to provide these comments.

I. Proposed Rollout Plan

Over the past several months, stakeholders engaged in facilitated dialogue to address the five directives established by PURA: cross-program coordination; technical requirements; program terms & conditions; incentive structures; and light-duty vs. med/heavy-duty. At the June 12, 2026, meeting of the Working Group, the Program Administrators (PAs) shared initial recommendations. VGIC welcomes the opportunity to offer our support for the recommendations with modifications as discussed below.

1. Launch the Residential Program for Bidirectional EVs in 2027

VGIC recommends that PURA direct the PAs to launch residential bidirectional EV participation in the ESS Program in 2027, rather than delaying residential participation pending additional pilot results. VGIC recognizes the value of the IES (Innovative Energy Solutions) pilots, the MassCEC V2X Pilot, and other early deployments in informing future program design. These efforts provide important information on installation costs, customer participation, technology

performance, enrollment processes, and implementation challenges. A durable program will allow the early momentum from these pilots to support market development.

Automakers are expanding the availability of vehicles that support grid-aware charging and bidirectional capabilities. Major manufacturers, including Ford, General Motors (Chevrolet, Cadillac, and GMC), Nissan, Kia, Volvo, and Polestar, are already marketing vehicles with features that enable managed charging or bidirectional energy flows. Tesla recently launched its PowerShare Grid Support offering in Texas, marking the first large-scale V2G program from a major automaker using a lower-cost AC-based architecture. Tesla has also announced plans to launch the same offering in California in coordination with the state's three major investor-owned utilities. In addition, manufacturers including Toyota, Honda and Acura, Rivian, Lucid, BMW, Volkswagen, and Stellantis have announced plans to introduce bidirectional capabilities across upcoming vehicle platforms. These announcements suggest that bidirectional functionality will become widely available across most major light-duty EV platforms within the next two to three years.

Charging equipment manufacturers are also bringing new bidirectional products to market. Companies including debel, Wallbox, Ford, GM Energy, and Tesla already offer bidirectional charging systems. Additional manufacturers, including Emporia, ChargePoint, Autel, SolarEdge, and Enphase, have announced upcoming products designed to support bidirectional operation. For example, Enphase has announced plans to begin volume production of its IQ Bidirectional EV Charging Platform in late 2026. Taken together, the industry is primed to deliver bidirectional charging solutions to residential customers at scale. By launching residential bidirectional EV participation through the ESS Program, Connecticut will send an important message to automobile OEMs and charger manufacturers that regulators understand the role bidirectional charging can play in supporting a lower-cost and more efficient grid.

VGIC recognizes that the Working Group identified several residential implementation issues, including coordination with managed charging, DERMS integration, enrollment processes, customer control, vehicle readiness, and the potential for multiple vendors to be involved at a single site. To address these issues, the PAs could initially limit participation through enrollment caps, allowing Connecticut to begin building operational experience while managing administrative complexity and customer experience risks.

Launching a residential program in 2027 would position Connecticut as a national leader in bidirectional charging policy. It would create a pathway for customers, manufacturers, installers, aggregators, and utilities to begin scaling residential bidirectional charging in a controlled and transparent manner. It would also ensure that Connecticut captures early learning from actual program participation, rather than relying only on pilots or experience from other jurisdictions.

VGIC therefore recommends that PURA direct the PAs to include residential bidirectional EVs in the ESS Program beginning in 2027, with a phased implementation structure that can be updated as the market matures.

2. Approve Proposals 1, 2, & 3 as Presented

VGIC supports approval of Proposals 1, 2, and 3 as presented. These proposals provide a workable foundation for incorporating bidirectional EVs-EVSE into the ESS Program while maintaining appropriate safety, technical, and administrative requirements.

VGIC supports Proposal 1, which would enroll the EVSE rather than the EV or the combined EV-EVSE system in the ESS Program. This approach is administratively practical and consistent with how distributed energy resource programs typically qualify and manage grid-connected equipment. The EVSE is the appropriate point of program enrollment because it is the equipment located at the customer site and connected to the electrical system for interconnection review and approval.

VGIC also supports Proposal 2, which would establish a Qualified Product List for EVSE rather than for vehicles. This is the right point of program qualification because the EVSE is the device that will interconnect with the customer site and meet the necessary safety requirements for interconnection. However, VGIC encourages the PAs to provide clarity on how they define both “vehicle-to-grid capable” and “DERMS integration.” The QPL must have explicit and clear requirements to avoid confusion and promote transparency.

VGIC supports Proposal 3, which would require bidirectional EVSE to follow appropriate UL 1741 certification pathways. DC-connected bidirectional charging systems should be eligible through UL 1741 SB, while AC-connected systems should be eligible through the forthcoming UL 1741 SC pathway or other applicable UL 1741 SB CRD (certification requirement decision) for paired EV/EVSE bidirectional charging system certification pathways. This distinction is important because DC and AC bidirectional charging systems are designed, certified, and deployed differently. Aligning ESS eligibility with the applicable interconnection certification pathways will provide clarity for customers, manufacturers, installers, utilities, and program administrators.

3. Modify Proposal 5 by Eliminating UL 9741 Requirement

VGIC further supports Proposal 5 with the modification to eliminate the UL 9741 requirement. VGIC supports the requirements for bidirectional EVSE to meet applicable safety standards, either UL 2202 or UL 2594, as applicable. However, it was recently brought to our attention that UL 9741 generally applies to DC-based bidirectional charging systems. Requiring devices to

meet UL 9741 could exclude AC bidirectional charging systems that follow the UL 1741 SC + SAE J3072 approach simply because UL 9741 doesn't cover that system architecture.

4. Modify Proposal 3 by Delaying ISO 15118-20 Requirement

As discussed in VGIC's earlier comments on communications standards, VGIC supports the long-term transition toward open, interoperable protocols, including ISO 15118-20 for bidirectional power transfer. However, VGIC recommends that PURA modify Proposal 4 by delaying any mandatory ISO 15118-20 requirement until third-party certification, testing infrastructure, and commercially available compliant products are sufficiently mature. Many bidirectional charging systems available today rely on proprietary or alternative communication approaches while still supporting safe operation, dispatch, telemetry, customer control, and performance verification. Making ISO 15118-20 a near-term eligibility requirement could therefore exclude certain commercially available products.

PURA should establish a defined grace period for bidirectional EVSE that meets the ESS Program's functional requirements but does not yet demonstrate ISO 15118-20 compliance. This phased approach would preserve early market momentum while providing a clear signal that the program will move toward standardized communication protocols over time. It would also maintain the program's safety and performance foundations by continuing to require applicable interconnection, certification, and program-dispatch requirements while avoiding a protocol-specific gatekeeping requirement before the market is ready.

5. Prepare Early for Solar Customer Participation

PURA should also direct the PAs to prepare early for participation by customers with existing solar systems. Residential bidirectional EV adoption is likely to overlap significantly with the same customer segment that has already installed rooftop solar, home batteries, smart panels, or other distributed energy resources. Early pilots have shown that integrating bidirectional EVs at these sites can be more complex than enrolling a stand-alone charger. Utilities, vendors, and installers may need to address interactions among solar inverters, EV chargers, backup power systems, meters, customer load panels, export limits, netting rules, and program dispatch requirements. Without early planning, these issues could slow enrollment, create inconsistent customer experiences, or lead to unnecessary interconnection and billing complications.

VGIC recommends that the PAs use the 2027 launch period to develop clear processes for solar-paired bidirectional EV systems. This should include standardized intake questions, installer guidance, metering and telemetry requirements, coordination with existing net metering or distributed generation tariffs, and clear rules for how bidirectional EV exports will be measured and compensated when located behind the same meter as solar. Preparing for solar customer

participation now will allow Connecticut to manage complexity in a controlled manner while avoiding the need to redesign the program after customers and vendors are already in the market.

II. Proposed Incentives

VGIC supports the PA's proposed incentive structure, particularly the decision to rely primarily on performance-based incentives for bidirectional EV participation in ESS program. This approach aligns compensation with the actual grid value delivered during dispatch events, and it is consistent with PURA's direction to move away from higher upfront incentives toward Construct 5, which places greater weight on measured performance. Because bidirectional EVs are transportation assets first and grid resources second, a performance-based structure appropriately rewards customers and aggregators when vehicles are available, enrolled, and discharging during system need.

VGIC also agrees that the incentive design should reflect cost-effectiveness considerations and the current maturity of the bidirectional charging market. The bidirectional EV working group discussions highlighted the fact that bidirectional EV costs and performance remain uncertain, particularly around bidirectional EVSE costs, interconnection, installation complexity, and expected event participation. In this context, performance-based incentives provide a practical near-term structure that supports commercial deployment while allowing the PA and PURA to gather data from early ESS program participation and related pilots. VGIC supports continuing to evaluate whether targeted upfront incentives may be appropriate in future program years, particularly for residential or priority customer segments, but agrees that the initial structure should emphasize performance, administrative simplicity, customer experience, and demonstrated cost-effective grid value.

III. Island Requirement

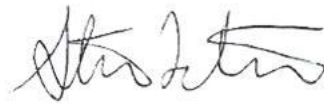
VGIC recommends that bidirectional EVs and EVSE be allowed, but not required, to provide home backup power or islanding capability as a condition of ESS Program participation. VGIC recognizes that resiliency is an important objective of the ESS Program and that islanding capability can provide meaningful customer value during outages. However, bidirectional EVs can provide grid value to the ESS Program through controlled export during active events even if the system does not also provide whole-home or partial-home backup power. Requiring islanding capability for all bidirectional EV systems would risk adding cost, installation complexity, and customer friction in ways that could slow early market participation without improving the system's ability to deliver performance during ESS dispatch events.

VGIC therefore recommends a flexible approach. Customers who want backup power should be permitted to install bidirectional EV systems with islanding capability. However, this capability should remain optional. For many customers, the incremental cost and complexity associated with backup power may exceed what is needed to safely export to the grid under ESS Program dispatch. Making backup power optional would preserve the resiliency pathway for customers who value it, while allowing other customers and aggregators to participate with simpler export-capable systems that meet applicable safety, interconnection, telemetry, and performance requirements. This approach better aligns program eligibility with the core ESS value stream: verified discharge during system need.

IV. Conclusion

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to participate in the Bidirectional EV Working Group and to provide these comments. VGIC supports the overall direction of the recommendations and commends the PAs for developing a thoughtful framework that recognizes the technical, administrative, and customer-experience issues associated with bringing bidirectional EV into the ESS Program.

Sincerely,



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